



'I am, we are ... different by design' is an annual student-led zine published by the Department of Typography & Graphic Communication at the University of Reading. This year, the zine was curated, collated and designed by Eleanor Denton, Aurelien Flatman, Grace Johnson, and Jess Scrivener.

This year's edition focuses on four themes: mental health, menstrual health, community & inclusion, and student finances. These were the most commonly raised issues that students in the School of Arts and Communication Design highlighted to us in a survey.

In the University's 100th year, we have brought together and presented under-represented student voices from across the School.

Design by Eleanor Denton



UoR Mental Health & Wellbeing



Bectu Creative Work Union



NABS Creative Career Support

I attended the
counselling
last year and
am attending
again this year,
after a second referral

STUDENT

Mental health has affected
my ~~attendance~~ and
commitment to work,
I have difficulty
completing **work**
on time

I found the
5 4 3 2 1 method
very helpful
during
panic ~~a t t a c k s~~

I've definitely
s t r u g g l e d
with depression
and an^xiety

I've experienced
severe anxiety,
depressive episodes
and
found it
difficult
to attend classes

VOICES*

*From the School of Arts
and Communication Design

It was a
nerve-wracking time
trying to meet
~~new people~~
and also learn
a completely
new subject

mental health
in creative
industries
mental health
in creative
industries
mental health
in creative
industries

Mental health includes our physical, emotional and psychological wellbeing.

Our mental health can greatly affect our creativity and how we see the world around us.

To anyone currently struggling with their mental health, consider indulging in your creative urges.

Designing can become a refuge during difficult times.

Sources
The big mental health report, (2024), Mind.
Long-standing health crisis in creative industries linked to passion driven work research finds, (2025), Creatives Unite.
Cover
Manipulation of *Shocking Wave* by Brodie Kaman

DID

Creative industries typically have

long work hours and precarious contracts

Working in media (creativity & storytelling) traps people in cycles of self-sacrifice

?

1 in 4 in England will experience a mental health problem at some point each year

YOU

YOU

1 in 5 children and young people in England have a mental health problem

Wide issues in journalism, advertising, film and content creation lead to anxiety and burnout

KNOW

1 in 8 young people aged 17-19 in England (2024), have an eating disorder or difficulty

YOU